a substantial number of AYUSH healthcare facilities, reflecting its commitment to holistic wellness. Currently, there are 544 government Ayurvedic and 5 government Unani healthcare hospitals, along with over 100 government homeopathic dispensaries and more than 10 government AYUSH Yoga centers.

Moreover, Uttarakhand boasts 20 government health wellness centers and 4 private sector AYUSH hospitals accredited by the National Accreditation Board for Hospitals & Healthcare Providers (NABH). To further enhance healthcare standards, the government aims to secure NABH accreditation for 150 government AYUSH hospitals this year, with a target to accredit another 150 in the subsequent phase.

In a bid to promote NABH accreditation within the private sector, the government will bear the amount of NABH accreditation fees. Uttarakhand endeavors to ensure accessibility to healthcare services for all, offering free government services to the underprivileged and outpatient services in private institutions at nominal fees. The state also boasts a considerable workforce dedicated to AYUSH, with over 5,000 registered AYUSH doctors and more than 6,000 paramedical staff, including pharmacists, nurses, and Panchakarma assistants, registered under the Medical Council of India. Presently, the AYUSH healthcare sector contributes significantly to Uttarakhand's GDP, estimated to range between Rs 150-250 crore, underscoring its economic and societal importance.

Uttarakhand's captivating tourist destinations are not just scenic marvels but also harbor natural healing properties. Sites like Tapta Kund and the Gangnani hot springs are renowned for their high sulfur content, believed to alleviate skin diseases and arthritis. The Himalayan waterfalls, lakes, and rivers contain high levels of magnesium, potassium, calcium, and antioxidants, which boost collagen production. Kasar Devi in Almora stands out as one of the world's top three geomagnetic zones, renowned for its high emission of cosmic energy. This unique characteristic has transformed it into a sought-after meditation destination, attracting illustrious personalities like Swami Vivekananda and Bob Dylan. Coupled with its serene climate and pristine environment, Uttarakhand emerges as an ideal hub for health tourism. The state hosts several esteemed wellness resort brands, such as Six Senses Vana, Ananda in the Himalayas, Taj Rishikesh, and Vedalife Retreats, offering an array of wellness therapies, yoga, meditation, and naturopathy treatments to visitors. The wellness sector significantly contributes to Uttarakhand's GDP, estimated to range between Rs 1,500-2,000 crore.

Uttarakhand Ayurved University (UAU) in Dehradun stands as the premier AYUSH institution in the state, with 22 affiliated colleges. Notably, the esteemed Gurukul and Rishikul Ayurved Colleges, boasting over a century of legacy, are integral parts of this university. Additionally, five Ayurveda colleges offer postgraduate programs in clinical and non-clinical streams.

The state also hosts 24 AYUSH paramedical colleges accredited by the Medical Council of India and seven paramedical colleges under the Homeopathic Medicine Board. The government mandates NAAC accreditation for all colleges to ensure quality education. Furthermore, to foster research and innovation in AYUSH, the state is establishing Central government research bodies like Regional Ayurvedic Research Institutes (RARIs) under the Central Council for Research in Ayurvedic Sciences (CCRAS). Every year, approximately 1,300-1,500 students graduate from AYUSH-related courses at the undergraduate and postgraduate levels in Uttarakhand, reflecting the state's commitment to nurturing skilled professionals in holistic healthcare.



> We are determined to establish Uttarakhand as world- renowned wellness destination providing best AYUSH services and an International hub for manufacturing of AYUSH medicines & consumer products. We are initiating every necessary step to achieve this goal.
>
> *— Pushkar Singh Dhami, Chief Minister, Uttarakhand*



POLICIES AS CATALYST

- AYUSH pharmacy manufacturing industries in the state will not only enjoy the benefits outlined in the MSME policy but will also receive an additional 10% subsidy for building, setting up plants, and machinery installation.
- AYUSH manufacturing units will be mandated to obtain the AYUSH Standard Mark for their products. Furthermore, a specialized homeopathic medicine testing laboratory will be established to ensure stringent quality control of homeopathic medicines within the state.
- To enhance the quality of education in Ayurveda colleges, a provision of incentive amount has been introduced based on NAAC grading. Colleges achieving A++ grading will receive Rs 15 lakh, A+ colleges Rs 10 lakh, A graded colleges Rs 5 lakh, and B++ graded colleges Rs 2.5 lakh.
- An internship program will be initiated for students enrolled in Ayurveda colleges within the state. International clinical studies and research on the integration of modern and traditional AYUSH medicines will be conducted through Rishikul and Gurukul colleges.
- The state aims to foster the AYUSH agriculture sector by establishing an integrated platform that connects medicinal plant farmers with buyers, facilitating the branding of Himalayan herbs.
- Plans are underway to organize world-class AYUSH fairs and seminars. Plan to organize international level World Arogya Expo and World Ayurveda Congress this year. Organization of AYUSH camps and seminars at major places like Secretariat, Raj Bhavan.
- During the Investors Summit held in December 2023, the state government signed an MoU on a proposal of Rs 17000 crore for investment in AYUSH-Healthcare, wellness, education, and manufacturing. Prime Minister Narendra Modi appreciated the miniature model of the proposed wellness center showcased at the AYUSH stall
- Aim to establish the Yoga and Wellness Centre, Ayush Gram in the state through external investment. Plan to connect homestays with yoga and wellness centers. Provision to give quality-based star ratings to wellness centres. There is also a plan to establish tele-medicine hub for AYUSH in state.